



Q. The film seems to blame you partly for not taking any action as CM and, in fact, for being lax and allowing the situation to get out of hand...
A. I don't think it is true. There will be people who will tell you various stories, but to know the truth, which will be very bitter, you need to have an honest, honourable retired judge or committee and form a Truth Commission. Only then will people know who is responsible. If Farooq Abdullah is responsible, he is ready to be hanged anywhere in the nation. I am ready to stand trial, but don't blame people who are not responsible. I want the commission to honestly investigate the killings of Sikhs and Muslims too in the Valley and the rape of Kashmiri women in Kupwara. The time has come for the nation to hear the truth and live with it.

Q. So, who is to blame?
A. Take the Rubaiya Sayeed kidnapping (in December 1989). I was chief minister then and the Government of India was led by V.P. Singh with support from the BJP. They wanted to release five of the people we had caught in exchange for her release, but I refused. I told them we shouldn't give in to terrorists who believed that if the Russians could be thrown out of Afghanistan, they could throw India out of Kashmir. I told them not to do it as it would be a terrible tragedy for the nation and we will pay a heavy price in the future. They didn't listen, so much so that I was told I would be dismissed if I didn't do it. I told them to give me in writing that their cabinet had asked for this, because what will happen now would be the last nail in the coffin of India and you will be responsible for it.

Q. Was that the turning point in the Valley then?
A. The other was the appointment of the governor (Jagmohan) soon after in January 1990. I told all the senior leaders in the central government not to send him as he had a Partition mindset and could not be the one to heal things.

"I want the Truth Commission to honestly investigate **the killings of Sikhs and Muslims too in the Valley, and the rape of women in Kupwara"**

I also told them they were fighting a war with Pakistan with me as the barrier, but if this in-between goes, they would be fighting directly with Pakistan. I said we would overcome, but for that, we needed all their help. And that I would leave if they appointed him. When they did, I resigned and left. On the third day of governor's rule, 30 people were killed in downtown Srinagar. Then the Pandits were driven off in buses out of the Valley (under the orders) of the governor, who told them he would use force to eliminate these people. But then they might retaliate, so it was better to leave and he would get them back once everything was alright. It is 32 years now. Are the Pandits back? Now they say that Farooq Abdullah is responsible. Where was Farooq Abdullah? It was your government in Delhi, and your governor here.

Q. Why do you think Yasin Malik and Bitta Karate have not been prosecuted so far despite the JKLF's alleged involvement in attacks against Kashmiri Pandits?
A. Did the National Conference release Bitta Karate or was it the Government of India? And on what basis did they release him? Then, when IC 814 was hijacked to Kandahar (in December 1999), who took Maulana Masood Azhar (chief of Jaish-e-Mohammad) and two others to secure the release of passengers? I told them that they were giving in to their game. I begged them not to do it and said it would be a great threat to our nation and a tragedy, but they didn't listen.

Q. Many say that the election held in the Valley after the 1987 Rajiv Gandhi-Farooq Abdullah accord was rigged and resulted in many Kashmiris losing faith in the democratic process and joining militancy...
A. If they say we rigged the election in 1987, I ask this nation why the people who made these charges did not go to the Election Commission or even the Supreme Court to protest. Didn't the courts throw Mrs Indira Gandhi out of power in 1975 for an election malpractice? And how did my senior minister lose the election? There may have been some malpractices—as elsewhere in